

50 WAYS TO MAKE

WONDERING HOW YOU CAN CONTRIBUTE TO THE GREENING OF INDIA? OR WHAT THE COUNTRY SHOULD

How Green is My Valley

Forests are one of the most effective carbon sinks and critical for preserving the ecological balance. The prime minister has announced a Green India campaign of afforesting six million hectares of degraded forests on an emergency basis, spending over Rs 6,000 crore initially. It would help reach the national target of having forest and tree cover over 33 per cent of the country's land area, up from the current 23 per cent. You can do your own bit by planting a tree in your garden.

AP PHOTO/ANUPAM NATH



Trading in Air

Trading in carbon credits will emerge as a huge business if a global compact on emissions reductions is reached. India already accounts for 32 per cent of the projects established under what is known as the Clean Development Mechanism (CDM). Also known as the cap and trade system, it allows companies in developed countries to meet their emission targets by buying credits from units which pollute less or investing in CDM projects in developing countries. India has a total of 493 million such Certified Emission Reductions or CERs. Under the action plan, India is to establish a market-based mechanism that would certify energy savings of Indian companies and enable them to trade in it.



RAVI S SAHANI

Electric Cars

If you are looking to buy a new car that would keep the air clean and be light on your purse then opt for an electric powered vehicle. Electric vehicles like the Reva (left) are ideal for city driving, are emission free, have a top speed of 40 to 60 kmph and run 50-80 kms before they need recharging. This could be done with the normal 15-ampere socket found at home and the battery takes seven hours to recharge fully. With the savings in fuel, you could recover the cost of the car in a little over three years.

Clean Coal

Many think the term is an oxymoron but various technologies are under development to clean the flue gases emitted by coal-fired power plants. The carbon dioxide is captured and sequestered in deep geological formations. It is expected to jack up costs considerably but that may be more than offset by the significant cut in carbon emissions.



Catch the Bus

The principal option for reducing energy use in our cities is to ensure that mass transportation is efficient, comfortable and reasonable. This would ensure that fewer people use cars or other forms of individual transport. By using CNG as a fuel in buses for public transport, emission levels could be significantly reduced. Metro rail services which run on electricity will also be a big help.

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